

Problem size	(a) Training Time Per Epoch (Mins) ($\downarrow$)		
	NELSON	Gibbs	CMSGen
10	0.53	9.85	0.69
20	0.53	80.12	1.93
30	0.72	256.38	3.65
40	0.93	777.01	5.99
50	1.17	T.O.	9.08
(b) Validness of Orientations (%) ($\uparrow$)			
7	100	50.16	100
8	100	64.63	100
9	100	47.20	100
10	100	62.60	100
11	100	84.95	100
(c) Approximation Error of $\nabla \log Z_C(\theta)$ ($\downarrow$)			
5	0.01	0.09	0.21
7	0.05	0.08	2.37
9	0.03	0.11	2.37
11	0.04	0.17	8.62
13	0.05	0.28	11.27
(d) MAP@10 (%) ($\uparrow$)			
10	61.14	60.01	64.56
20	55.26	55.20	47.79
30	100.00	96.29	100.00
40	40.01	39.88	38.90
50	46.12	T.O.	42.11

Table 3: Sample efficiency and learning performance of the sink-free orientation task. NELSON is the most efficient (see Training Time Per Epoch) and always generates valid assignments (see Validness), has the smallest error approximating gradients, and has the best learning performance (see MAP@10) among all baselines.

training set, we use the Erdős-Rényi random graph from the NetworkX library. The problem size is characterized by the number of vertices in the graph. The baselines we consider are CD-based learning with Gibbs sampling and CMSGen.

Learning Quality In Table ??(a), we show the proposed NELSON method takes much less time to train MRF for one epoch than the competing approaches. Furthermore, in Table ??(b), NELSON and CMSGen generate 100% valid orientations of the graph while the Gibbs-based model does not. Note the constraints for this task satisfy Condition ??, hence NELSON sampler’s performance is guaranteed by Theorem ??. In Table ??(c), NELSON attains the smallest approximation error for the gradient (in Eq. ??) compared to baselines. Finally, NELSON learns a higher MAP@10 than CMSGen. The Gibbs-based approach times out for problem sizes larger than 40. In summary, our NELSON is the best-performing algorithm for this task.

Learn Vehicle Delivery Routes

Task Definition & Dataset Given a set of locations to visit, the task is to generate a sequence to visit these locations in which each location is visited once and only once and the sequence closely resembles the trend presented in the training data. The training data are such routes collected



Figure 3: Frequency histograms for the number of resample and the total time of NELSON method for uniformly sampling visiting paths for vehicle routing problem.

in the past. The dataset is constructed from TSPLIB, which consists of 29 cities in Bavaria, Germany. The constraints for this problem do not satisfy Condition ??. We still apply the proposed method to evaluate if the NELSON algorithm can handle those general hard constraints.

In Fig. ??, we see NELSON can obtain samples of this delivery problem efficiently. We measure the number of resamples taken as well as the corresponding time used by the NELSON method. NELSON takes roughly 50 times of resamples with an average time of 0.3 seconds to draw a batch (the batch size is 100) of valid visiting sequences.

Conclusion

In this research, we present NELSON, which embeds a sampler based on Lovász Local Lemma into the contrastive divergence learning of Markov random fields. The embedding is fully differentiable. This approach allows us to learn generative models over constrained domains, which presents significant challenges to other state-of-the-art models. We also give sound proofs of the performance of the LLL-based sampler. Experimental results on several real-world domains reveal that NELSON learns to generate 100% valid structures, while baselines either time out or cannot generate valid structures. NELSON also outperforms other approaches in the running times and in various learning metrics.

Acknowledgments

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